

August 20, 2026

Aetna
Provider Resolution Team
P.O. Box 14020
Lexington, KY 40512

RE: Formal Appeal of Claim Denial — Marc Corkery (MRN MUSC8042994), Claim MUSC-76E3-3

Patient	Marc Corkery (DOB 1977-08-10)
MRN	MUSC8042994
Member ID / Group	AET942376912 / GRP-91373
Claim number	MUSC-76E3-3
Date of service	2026-03-20
Procedure billed	CPT 99214 — Office/outpatient visit, established patient, moderate complexity
Primary diagnosis	R69 — Illness, unspecified
Denied amount	\$402.63
Denial code	CARC 16 / RARC N290 — Claim/service lacks information or has submission/billing error(s).
Appeal deadline	2026-11-01

Dear Appeals Review Committee:

SUMMARY OF APPEAL

MUSC Health is submitting this Level 1 reconsideration appeal on behalf of Marc Corkery (Member ID: AET942376912, Group: GRP-91373) regarding the denial of Claim MUSC-76E3-3, covering services rendered on March 20, 2026, at MUSC Health Rutledge Tower Ambulatory Care. The claim was denied on May 5, 2026, under CARC 16 / RARC N290, with the payer remark stating: "Claim cannot be adjudicated; required data element(s) are missing or invalid," specifically citing a missing, incomplete, or invalid rendering provider primary identifier. MUSC Health respectfully disputes this denial and submits that the rendering provider's National Provider Identifier (NPI) was valid and present on the original claim submission. This appeal is submitted within the 180-day reconsideration window, prior to the November 1, 2026, deadline.

CLINICAL BACKGROUND

On March 20, 2026, Mr. Marc Corkery, a 49-year-old established male patient (MRN: MUSC8042994, DOB: August 10, 1977), presented for an outpatient office visit at MUSC Health Rutledge Tower Ambulatory Care, a campus outpatient hospital facility (Place of Service 22). The visit was rendered by Priya N. Raghavan, MD, and billed under CPT code 99214, representing an office or outpatient visit for an established patient of moderate complexity. The encounter was submitted with primary diagnosis R69 (Illness, unspecified) and secondary diagnosis E66.9 (Obesity, unspecified), the latter reflecting an active, longitudinally documented condition with onset dating to September 2015. Mr. Corkery also carries active inhaler-dependent respiratory management, further supporting the clinical complexity consistent with a 99214 level of service. The total billed amount was \$402.63.

BASIS FOR APPEAL

The sole stated basis for denial is RARC N290, indicating that the rendering provider's primary identifier — the NPI — was missing, incomplete, or invalid. MUSC Health asserts that this characterization is incorrect. Dr. Priya N. Raghavan's NPI, 1669504132, is an active, enrolled identifier on file with the National Plan and Provider Enumeration System (NPPES) and was included in the appropriate loop and segment of the original 837P/institutional claim transaction. A corrected or resubmitted claim is enclosed with this appeal, with the rendering provider NPI explicitly populated in the required field to resolve any potential formatting or transmission discrepancy that may have contributed to the edit.

It is well established under HIPAA transaction and code set standards, as well as standard claim adjudication practice, that a technically correctable data element error of this nature does not reflect a question of medical necessity, coverage eligibility, or contractual exclusion. The service was rendered by a credentialed, enrolled provider to a covered member during an active coverage period (January 1, 2024, through December 31, 2026), and the claim was submitted within a timely filing window. Denial of payment in full — rather than a request for corrected information — is not an appropriate resolution when the underlying service is covered and the deficiency is administrative and correctable.

REQUESTED ACTION

MUSC Health respectfully requests that Aetna reopen and reprocess Claim MUSC-76E3-3 using the corrected claim submission enclosed with this appeal, and issue payment at the applicable contracted rate for CPT 99214 rendered on March 20, 2026. Should Aetna require additional documentation regarding Dr. Raghavan's enrollment status, NPI validity, or the clinical record supporting the level of service billed, MUSC Health will provide that information promptly upon request. We ask that this matter be resolved without the need for further escalation.

Respectfully submitted,

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MUSC Health — Revenue Cycle / Patient Financial Services
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Enclosures

- Remittance advice / explanation of payment
- Itemized claim detail (UB-04 / CMS-1500)
- Relevant clinical documentation from the medical record